

1 INSTALLING & CONFIGURING WORDPRESS



WordPress is one of the simplest open source blogging platforms to install. It has the famous “five-minute install” to its credit. In fact, installing WordPress can take a lot lesser than five minutes if you are familiar with the creation of a database on your web site. This process can be nearly instantaneous if you’re a power user who can script the database creation, or a minute or two if a web host control panel login is required. Most web servers today are already set up out of the box to handle WordPress. If you have PHP 4.3 or higher, and MySQL 4.1.2 or higher on your server, then you will not have any major issue installing WordPress.

1.1 System requirements

The only minimum requirement for installing WordPress is the PHP scripting language and a web server. The recommended system essentials are PHP 5, MySQL 5, and Apache 2 on a Unix-variant operating system such as the ones most hosting companies provide in their Linux packages.

The foundational building blocks of WordPress are the PHP scripting language and the MySQL database. Though it is technically possible to run WordPress on a different database than MySQL, it is impossible to run WordPress without PHP.

Perhaps the most important area for system optimization is the MySQL database, at large scale. Some of the most intensive activity in the WordPress system architecture occurs here. Out of the box, MySQL is not optimised for heavy WordPress. It works well only with small blogs. After that, it begins to bog down.

1.2 Choosing a web server

In most cases, the choice of web server is something that is pretty standard. Most web hosts provide Linux hosting with Apache as the configured web server. In most cases, the choice is automatic because it is the web server that comes with virtually every distribution of Linux and is turned on, almost universally, by default.

With rare exception, these hosts are perfectly fine out of the box. Little additional configuration is needed to run a small blog. However, you should be a little cautious and ensure that the host has the minimum software